

INSIDE ARG

Investigation status and verification handoff

As of September 27, 2026, 10:02 p.m. EDT. PDF prepared September 27, 2026.

Status: The collector's-edition sticker data support a 108-position repeating symbol sequence. No plaintext has been established. It remains unresolved whether the repetition serves a puzzle, reflects manufacturing, or both.

Immediate obstacle: The community's labeled 3 x 3 background-image assembly has not been retrieved. Its verified A-I placement is required before the proposed jigsaw-based symbol pictures can be assembled without guessing.

The user reports independent reproduction of several findings. The external model's complete code and outputs have not been inspected in this investigation. No unknown symbol has been filled to manufacture a phrase, and no completed ARG solution is claimed.

1. Evidence and conventions

Primary dataset: the community repository maintained by twinsam, pinned to commit:

4de72d7c2f21bd9eb4144fda51281c84cbcb90c4

The snapshot contains 82 numbered sticker observations. The photographs and transcriptions were collected by community contributors; this investigation analyzes that work and does not claim priority over undocumented Discord findings. [1, 2]

Symbol	Sticker observations
Slash /	47
Dash -	28
Dot .	7

- Cycle positions are one-based: $\text{position} = ((\text{sticker_number} - 1) \bmod 108) + 1$.
- Background letter = "ABCDEFGH I"[(sticker_number - 1) mod 9].
- A question mark means unknown and is never silently filled.
- Repeated stickers occupying one cycle position count once when describing the cycle.

2. The 108-position cycle

An exhaustive period scan from 1 through 300 found four contradiction-free periods: **108, 197, 216 and 254**. The shortest is 108. The alternatives have fewer overlapping observations; 216 is also a multiple of 108.

The 82 observations fill **65 positions**, leaving **43 unknowns**. Fifteen positions have multiple observations, producing 19 agreeing pairwise comparisons. Those comparisons are not independent: there are 17 observations beyond the first observation in each filled position.

The corrected cycle, displayed as three rows of 36, is:

?/- -/?/?/-?/-/?/- -/?/- -?--?/?// -/???/
-///?// -?///??-?-??/-?///?/?//?/?/---
?--/?////?/??./??.?.??./?..??/?????/?/

Position 44 is a known dash, supplied by sticker 476. Its photograph was inspected. A previously supplied transcription incorrectly showed a question mark there.

Two exploratory randomization tests each used 100,000 trials and seed 20260927:

Null model	Trials with any contradiction-free period at or below 108
Shuffle symbols globally, preserving counts	0 / 100,000
Shuffle symbols within each background-image group	0 / 100,000

These results reject those particular random-assignment models. They do not establish a zero probability of chance, prove an encoded message, or exclude manufacturing structure.

Further checks: removing sticker 597 still leaves 108 as the shortest fitting period. A November 2025 snapshot with 77 observations also yields 108. **Removing all seven dot observations still leaves 108 as the shortest fitting period.**

3. Dot clustering

Dot sticker	Cycle position	Background
193	85	D
413	89	H
306	90	I
92	92	B
95	95	E
97	97	G
206	98	H

All seven observed dots occupy distinct positions within 85-98, a 14-position window. Under the specified null, seven positions are selected uniformly without replacement from 108.

Event	Probability	Approximately
Inside a particular 14-position window fixed beforehand	1.23085 x 10^-7	1 in 8,124,481
Inside any nonwrapping 14-position window	5.90807 x 10^-6	1 in 169,260
Inside any circular 14-position window	6.64658 x 10^-6	1 in 150,453

The circular calculation is $P = 108 \times C(13,6) / C(108,7)$, where $C(n,k)$ is the binomial coefficient. The denominator is 27,883,218,168. The circular numerator is 185,328; the nonwrapping numerator is 164,736.

The circular result is appropriate for a cluster noticed after inspecting the cycle. It does not account for every possible investigation-level selection effect, and should not be multiplied by the earlier permutation results as though statistically independent.

Correction: positions 85-108 are not all dots. Positions **86, 96, 101 and 108** are known slashes.

4. Symbol distribution by background image

Each image owns 12 cycle positions. These counts are for distinct positions, not all 82 sticker observations.

Image	Dash	Slash	Dot	Unknown
A	3	1	0	8
B	1	8	1	2
C	5	4	0	3
D	2	3	1	6
E	2	4	1	5
F	2	6	0	4
G	1	3	1	7
H	4	2	2	4
I	2	5	1	4
Total	22	36	7	43

B is slash-dominated: 8 of 10 known positions. C is mildly dash-heavy: five dashes versus four slashes. The dot-background multiset is B, D, E, G, H, H, I. These are descriptive counts; no separate significance test for this association has been established.

5. Comparison against known printer strings

Sources: the community printer document and Game Detectives transcription. [3, 4] Each complete listed string was slid over all 108 circular starting positions. Known symbols had to agree literally; only question marks acted as wildcards. No reversal, substitution, insertion or row rearrangement was allowed.

Set	Entries tested	Compatible placements
PC long, 32 characters	32	0
PC short	9	34
Xbox long, 36 characters	36, including one duplicate	0
Xbox short	12	0

Of the 34 short-PC placements, 32 do not wrap and ten lie entirely within unknown positions. For example, PC string --/. fits positions 3-6, currently --/?.

Supported conclusion: no documented full-length PC or Xbox line fits literally anywhere in the partial cycle.

Not established: that the sticker sequence is definitively new material rather than a transformed or rearranged use of earlier material. Short-string compatibility is not a confirmed occurrence.

6. Binary comparisons against LIFEDETECTED

The exact target is uppercase LIFEDETECTED, containing 12 letters. Seven-bit ASCII uses 84 bits; five-bit A=1 through Z=26 uses 60 bits. Bits are most-significant first. Both slash/dash polarities were tested. Dots and question marks remained unconstrained.

Encoding and scan	/ = 1, - = 0: minimum conflicts	/ = 0, - = 1: minimum conflicts
Seven-bit, nonwrapping	18	18
Seven-bit, all circular offsets	16	14
Five-bit, nonwrapping	9	5
Five-bit, all circular offsets	9	5

The independently supplied 18/5 result is reproduced for a nonwrapping scan. Circular scanning lowers the ASCII minimum to 14.

- Best circular ASCII alignment: starts at position 30, slash = 0; 14 conflicts, 28 agreements and 42 unconstrained positions.
- Best five-bit alignments: start at 45 or 55, slash = 0; each has five conflicts, 21 agreements and 34 unconstrained positions.
- Start 45 does not wrap. Its conflicting positions are 46, 47, 53, 70 and 71.

Neither encoding fits. Unknown values cannot eliminate hard conflicts.

7. Braille checks completed

For the straight three-row by 36-column layout, cells have two columns and three rows. Every nonwrapping cell origin was tested. A reading is reported only when all six positions are known. Different alignments and overlapping cells are not concatenated.

Mapping	Fully determined result
Dots raised, unrotated	Two blank cells and . (dot 3 only)
Dots raised, rotated 90 degrees clockwise	Three blank cells
Dashes raised, rotated 90 degrees clockwise	Isolated ¨ , : and .

The dash mapping reflects the documented Xbox extraction more closely, but the sticker layout has no established circular outline or interior mask. [3] These isolated patterns do not establish a message.

For this specific straight layout, positions 93, 54 and 61 would each complete a currently dot-bearing cell. These priorities must not be represented as findings about the unassembled jigsaw layout.

8. Jigsaw-tile experiment: prepared, not assembled

The community's labeled assembly is image 846shEE.jpg. [5] It could not be retrieved in the analysis session. Linked historical Discord copies also failed. **The actual nine-letter slot order has not been verified.**

The tile inputs were computed by taking positions letter_index + 9k, with A=1 through I=9 and k=0 through 11, in increasing order:

Tile	Twelve symbols
A	?-?-/?????
B	/????/-?.
C	---///-???
D	-/?-/???.??
E	/--/?/??.?
F	?/-?-///?/?
G	/???/?-/?.
H	?/-?-?-/?..?
I	/-?/?/?-/?..?

Six block variants were generated: three wide by four tall, and four wide by three tall, each filled row-major, by alternating-direction rows, or column-major. Row serpentine begins left-to-right on the top row and reverses on alternate rows. Column-major proceeds top-to-bottom, then moves right.

Cells entirely within individual tiles were checked at 0, 90, 180 and 270 degrees. Every fully known nonblank dot-as-raised cell found in that restricted test contained one raised point. No phrase was established.

Not yet completed: placement of the nine blocks in community order; the six complete symbol pictures; dash/slash continuity across boundaries; overall dot geometry; Braille cells crossing boundaries; and ranking unknown positions for the strongest assembled-layout candidate.

Required input: the labeled image, or its nine letters in reading order from top-left to bottom-right. No alphabetical arrangement has been substituted.

9. Manufacturing explanation

Standard 108-label sheets exist:

- SheetLabels SL716: 0.75-inch square labels, 108 per letter-size sheet. [6]
- Creative Label Concepts 9-12C_5034: 0.75-inch circles, explicitly nine across by twelve down. [7]

No public production specification was found connecting these products to iam8bit's INSIDE stickers. Current product listings do not establish availability or use during the historical production run.

No explicit sticker measurement or original backing-sheet specification was found in the reviewed public repository, sticker catalogue or research account. [1, 2, 8] Discord's complete history and private correspondence were not searched.

A repeated sheet of 108 fixed artworks with advancing serial numbers could produce the observed cycle. Merely having 108 labels per sheet does not automatically produce such a cycle. Intentional puzzle content and a repeated manufacturing template can coexist.

Unresolved: actual sticker dimensions, backing-sheet geometry, artwork placement and numbering workflow. A measurement would test the specific 0.75-inch products; it would not alone exclude a larger custom 108-up printing layout.

10. JPEG-page recovery

Target: the terminal41.link page at dat/534brn9653f9j8mmd/. [9]

The repository copy and public mirror were fetched and found identical: 16,922 bytes, with 2,047 literal UTF-8 U+FFFD replacement characters. SHA-256:

```
d663d180f340b792e1bd4dbd8e8400e3b89da1c97af251b32d49735005273fa8
```

JPEG remnants and HTML-serialization artifacts support lossy text handling. They do not establish when or where the damage occurred. Changing character encoding cannot uniquely restore information already discarded by replacement decoding.

Wayback raw id_ requests using these timestamp selectors returned HTTP 404 archive error pages:

```
20200421000000
20200421064134
20211231000000
```

These are requested selectors, not recovered capture dates. Availability queries returned no snapshots for the tested URL forms; one successful CDX prefix query returned an empty list. Other index attempts encountered a 503 or timeout.

No original archived payload was recovered. The existing reproduction package contains 13 request records and hashes for the 12 returned bodies. Error pages without U+FFFD are not successful JPEG recoveries.

11. Missing evidence and next verification steps

The 43 unfilled cycle positions are:

```
1, 6, 8, 11, 16, 22, 25, 27, 28, 33, 34, 35,
41, 45, 49, 50, 52, 54, 55, 58, 61, 62, 64,
67, 68, 73, 77, 82, 83, 84, 87, 88, 91, 93,
94, 99, 100, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107
```

The missing classes inside the observed dot window are 87, 88, 91, 93 and 94. Their values remain unknown. For any missing position p , candidate sticker numbers are $p+108k$. The existing checklist lists $k=0$ through 4; it does not assert that every candidate exists.

Recommended verification order:

1. Independently regenerate the cycle and counts from the pinned sticker catalogue.
2. Check the binary tests with explicit wraparound and polarity conventions.
3. Supply and verify the jigsaw's nine-letter arrangement.
4. Assemble all six block variants before choosing a preferred layout; record both favorable and unfavorable results.

5. Obtain fresh photographs testing already-filled dot predictions, particularly sticker 200, alongside photographs filling unknown positions.
6. Obtain a ruler photograph, backing sheet or production template.
7. Seek an original HTTP/WARC payload or contemporary untouched copy of the JPEG page.

Branch	Current stopping point
Jigsaw assembly	Verified A-I slot order unavailable
Manufacturing explanation	No measured sticker or documented production layout
JPEG recovery	No intact original payload retrieved
Message extraction	All tested readings lack a justified phrase
Discovery priority	Complete Discord solving history not reviewed

12. Sources and companion evidence

- [1] Community repository and pinned revision:
<https://github.com/twinysam/INSIDE-ARG/tree/4de72d7c2f21bd9eb4144fda51281c84cbcb90c4>
- [2] Sticker catalogue: <https://github.com/twinysam/INSIDE-ARG/blob/master/stickers.md>
- [3] Community printer research:
<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1vlpah0LdCRpJe-OfhnkaiBlcmepGXust5BMbaFJGGt8/edit>
- [4] Game Detectives overview: https://wiki.gamedetectives.net/w/Inside_ARG
- [5] Labeled jigsaw image, inaccessible during the analysis session: <https://i.imgur.com/846shEE.jpg>
- [6] SheetLabels SL716: <https://www.sheetlabels.com/labels/SL716>
- [7] Creative Label Concepts / BrownKraftLabels product 9-12C_5034: https://www.browkraftlabels.com/items/white-high-gloss-laser-labels/white-high-gloss-round-laser-labels/3-4-diameter-round-white-high-gloss-laser-label-sheet-br-usually-ships-same-day-hg9-12c_5034-detail.htm
- [8] Raezores research account: <https://github.com/twinysam/INSIDE-ARG/blob/master/raezores-research.md>
- [9] Original JPEG-page target: <http://terminal41.link/dat/534brn9653f9j8mmd/> ; preserved mirror:
<http://534brn9653f9j8mmd.surge.sh/>

Existing companion files, not embedded in this PDF:

- INSIDE-ARG-Investigation-2026-09-27.md
- INSIDE-ARG-Reproduction-2026-09-27.zip
- INSIDE-ARG-43-Position-Checklist.md

Version note: those companion files include the cycle, clustering, printer comparisons, straight-layout Braille, archive attempts and checklist. The latest binary comparisons and preliminary tile checks are documented in this PDF and have not been added to those older files.

Evidence standard: observations, computed results and hypotheses remain separate. No unknown symbol has been assigned to make a phrase. No completed ARG solution or exclusive discovery is claimed.